

All You Need to Know About Samsung's Tizen OS!

Tizen has been under development since 2012, and it's now ready to challenge Google's dominant Android OS. This emerging OS is going to be a crucial part of Samsung's Internet of Things strategy too.

The New Year has just begun and there is some mind-blowing news already coming from the tech industry, courtesy the recently concluded CES 2015. For starters, the largest smartphone maker in the world, Samsung, has made significant progress as far as the Tizen OS, its in-house rival to Google's Android operating system, is concerned. Samsung launched the Tizen-based SUHD TVs at the Las Vegas tech show, and now a Tizen smartphone has been launched in the Indian market. The South Korean smartphone manufacturer has promised that, throughout 2015, a number of Tizen-based devices will be launched.

This is a major step towards building a powerful alternative to Google's dominant Android platform. The Indian launch of the Samsung Z1 smartphone, which runs on the Tizen OS, has happened after a year marked by frustrations and disappointments, as the company faced various challenges in the highly competitive mobile software and services market, which is dominated by Google and Apple. However, Tizen does have a long way to go before it can taste success at par with Google's Android.

The history behind Tizen

So far, Samsung has been a leader in the sales of Android smartphones. Android is considered as the leading mobile OS in the world with a 75 per cent share of the smartphone market. But Samsung had other plans up its sleeve too, and the company started working on an in-house open source mobile software called Tizen, along with Intel and the Linux Foundation. Tizen was created from Intel and Nokia's MeeGo and later, Samsung added aspects of its own Bada OS into Tizen in February 2013. The South Korean giant was never successful with its Bada OS-based handsets but turned into a household name with its Android phones. Elsewhere, Nokia had

formed a partnership with Intel to develop an open source Linux-based operating system, called Moblin, and later it got merged with MeeGo, resulting in several delays. And then, Nokia chose to adopt the Windows Phone OS for its Lumia range of smartphones.

After the Nokia-Intel project was abandoned, Samsung expressed interest in an Intel project, which led to the creation of Tizen, a Linux-based operating system.



Since 2012, Tizen has been undergoing development and now it's ready to challenge Google's Android OS. It's very unlikely that Samsung will stop supporting Android anytime soon. Yet, Tizen appears to have a promising future and experts describe it as the 'Android killer'. At the moment, however,

it cannot be predicted whether Tizen will arrest the dominance of Android or not. Earlier, in 2011, Samsung had abandoned its LiMo OS project.

Tizen's most outstanding features

- It is open source:** Being an open source platform like Android, hardware manufacturers can customise Tizen's interface and the UI as per their customers' requirements, to make the design as unique as possible. Samsung has adopted some of the most interesting features from Bada and incorporated them into Tizen.
- Use of HTML5:** Tizen is based on HTML5, and its apps have been written with HTML5. Content creators would be really delighted with this news as the platform would require shorter development cycles, and making apps will be less expensive too. Users will also get a smoother experience on their smartphones and while using Web applications in other devices running on the operating system. Videos can also be embedded without any extra plugins, as native support is provided to graphic content. iOS and Android platforms use Java and Object-C as